

FOODFUSION EDUCATIONAL GUIDE

The Science of Flavor Pairing and Aromatics

Balancing the Five Tastes

Every memorable dish balances sweet, sour, salty, bitter, and umami. Use tamarind, lime, or vinegar to brighten rich fats.

The Maillard Reaction

Sear proteins in a dry, smoking-hot pan to develop hundreds of aromatic flavor compounds and deep golden coloration.

Fat-Soluble Aromatics

Bloom whole spices, turmeric, chili powders, and shallots in warm oil first to unlock deep volatile aromatics.

Layering Texture and Contrast

Pair creamy elements (like coconut broth or warm tofu) with crispy crackers, roasted nuts, or fresh herbs.